

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

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WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 37645.59 ▼ 320.01 0.84%

NASDAQ 15267.91 ▼ 2.1%

STOXX 600 486.91 ▲ 2.7%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 25/32, yield 4.259%

OIL \$59.58 ▼ \$1.12

GOLD \$2,968.40 ▲ \$17.10

EURO \$1.0959

YEN 146.28

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Trump imposed** more tariffs on nearly 100 nations, hiking U.S. duties to the highest level since before World War II and sparking a race among many targeted countries to renegotiate terms. **A1, A4, A6, B1, B3**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rode a roller coaster, with the S&P 500 first rising about 4% before slumping to close 1.6% lower. The Nasdaq ended down 2.2% and the Dow shed 0.8%. **A1**

◆ **Representatives of top** European auto manufacturers met with European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen and urged politicians on both sides of the Atlantic to lower tariffs. **B3**

◆ **Harley-Davidson said** it engaged a search firm to find a replacement for Chief Executive Jochen Zeitz, who the company said plans to retire. **B1**

◆ **Healthcare company** Stada postponed its initial public offering in Germany, the latest IPO candidate to put flotation plans on hold as markets gyrate. **B1**

◆ **U.S. consumers** rushed to buy new iPhones over the past week, expecting that new tariffs will prompt Apple to raise prices. **B1**

◆ **Walgreens posted** higher sales in its latest quarter on growth in retail pharmacy sales in the U.S. as the company counts down its remaining months as a public company. **B2**

◆ **CVS Health appointed** Brian Newman as its CFO effective April 21. **B2**

◆ **Cryptocurrency firm** Ripple said it would acquire credit network Hidden Road for \$1.25 billion. **B4**

World-Wide

◆ **Palestinians entered** a leadership crisis in the absence of a third political force that might break the duopoly of Hamas and groups like it and Fatah. **A1**

◆ **The Supreme Court** lifted a lower court order that blocked the Trump administration from firing some 16,000 federal employees. **A3**

◆ **A judge ordered** the White House to restore the Associated Press's access to presidential events, saying the decision to impose limitations violated the news organization's free-speech rights. **A2**

◆ **Acting IRS Commissioner** Melanie Krause plans to leave the agency soon, a development that comes after a data-sharing agreement between the IRS and immigration authorities became official. **A2**

◆ **The Trump administration** has frozen more than \$1 billion in federal funding for Cornell University and \$790 million for Northwestern. **A3**

◆ **The Justice Department** scaled back prosecutors' ability to bring criminal charges against crypto firms. **A2**

◆ **Iran's nuclear progress** since the negotiation of a 2015 deal makes it harder to limit Tehran's advance toward weapons capability. **A7**

◆ **Ukraine said it** captured two Chinese citizens fighting in the Russian army and said evidence suggests there are "significantly more." **A16**

◆ **The IMF agreed** to provide Argentina with a multibillion-dollar loan that President Milei had lobbied for with Trump administration officials. **A16**

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Scientists Aim to Mirror Long-Extinct Wolf



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PAWS FOR REFLECTION: A U.S. firm says it created genetically engineered wolves that may resemble dire wolves, extinct for more than 10,000 years. Romulus and Remus are much larger than gray wolves, their closest living relatives. **A3**

Broad U.S. Tariffs Take Effect As China Vows ‘Fight to the End’

A drawn-out brawl between the global economic powers ramps up global risk

By GAVIN BADE AND JASON DOUGLAS

President Trump at 12:01 a.m. Wednesday imposed more tariffs on nearly 100 nations, hiking U.S. duties to the highest level since before World War II and sparking a race among many targeted nations to renegotiate terms of trade with the U.S.

The levies were part of what Trump has called his reciprocal tariff regime, taking

aim at nations that his administration considers bad actors on trade.

Many southeast Asian nations were hardest hit, with Vietnam, Laos and Cambodia receiving tariff hikes of over 45%. China will receive an 84% tariff hike, putting Trump's tariffs on all Chinese imports at 104%.

Including levies on certain products from before Trump's second term, the average tariff rate on China is estimated at around 125%. Trump's team has said that countries may be able to negotiate lower tariffs by decreasing their own duties and ending nontariff barriers on U.S. goods, but no deals have yet been reached.

In many cases, those reciprocal tariff amounts appear to match a basic formula: the size of a country's goods-trade imbalance with the U.S., divided by how much America imports from that nation.

Meanwhile, Beijing has threatened to "fight to the end," with both countries digging in for a protracted battle that lays bare the global economic fault line at the heart of the trade war.

While Trump has dramatically expanded his broadsides over trade to encompass allies and adversaries alike, China remains his foremost target. That reflects not just the intensifying geopolitical rivalry but also China's 20 years of

growing trade surpluses with the U.S. that Trump has said has been ruinous for U.S. jobs and industries.

Even as other countries make a beeline to strike deals with the White House, there will likely be no end to trade upheavals as long as that gap between the world's two largest economies persists. A drawn-out brawl heightens the risk of major disruption to international commerce and

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◆ **Many U.S. firms call their links to China durable....** **A4**
◆ **Shrimpers feel hopeful about tariffs.....** **A6**
◆ **iPhone users rush upgrades to avoid price hikes.....** **B1**

Massive Selloff Batters Buyers On Dip

S&P 500 closes below 5000 for first time in nearly a year as early rally fizzles

By KRISTAL HUR AND HANNAH ERIN LANG

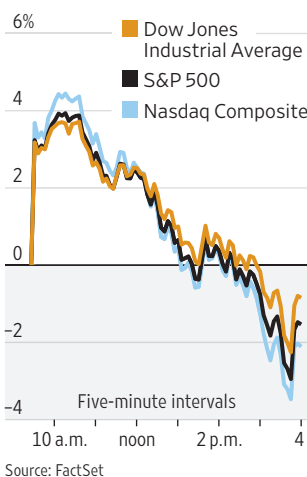
Investors who stepped in to buy the dip on Tuesday suffered a historic reversal when stocks gave up big opening gains and dove into the red during the afternoon.

Hopes that negotiations can limit the economic damage from President Trump's trade war initially sent major indexes soaring, driving the Dow Jones Industrial Average up around 1,400 points in early trading. Stocks skidded in the afternoon, with the blue-chip index falling about 320 points and the Nasdaq Composite sliding from a 4.6% gain to a 2.1% decline in its biggest blown gain in more than 40 years.

The S&P 500 initially rose about 4% before slumping to close 1.7% lower, the first time it closed below 5000 in about a

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Index performance Tuesday



◆ **Heard on the Street: Yields stay high for Treasuries...** **B12**

Rudderless Leadership, Divisions Hamstring Palestinians

By MARCUS WALKER

RAMALLAH, West Bank—The Palestinians' national cause has reached its lowest ebb in nearly 80 years, and there is no one to turn it around.

The Gaza Strip is in ruins. Many residents might leave or be pushed out following the war sparked by the Oct. 7, 2023, attacks. Palestinian territory in the West Bank is divided by ever-expanding Israeli settlements. Middle East countries have been building ties with Israel, and allies such as Iran and the Lebanese militia Hezbollah were battered by Israeli attacks last year.

Palestinians, meanwhile, are fighting with each other, caught between violent groups such as Hamas and the secular nationalist party Fatah, which governs parts of the West Bank and is widely seen as corrupt and ineffective.

No third force has been able to break that duopoly. No new generation is emerging in either party to offer a fresh vision or strategy.

"I hate the two factions," said Noha Kamal, a mother of three from Rafah in southern Gaza who has had to flee with her family from their largely flattened city. "If it weren't for their division, we wouldn't have ended up in this situation."

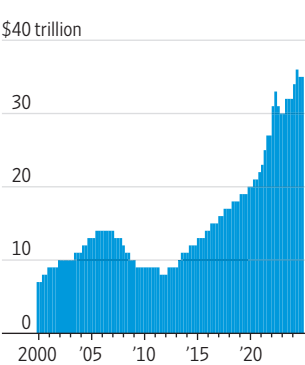
That widely held frustration has burst out in sporadic street protests in Gaza, and

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Homeowners Amassed \$35 Trillion In Housing Wealth—But at a Cost

Surging home equity brings higher expenses, and tapping into the wealth is difficult

Quarterly home equity value over time



Source: Federal Reserve

By VERONICA DAGHER AND ANNE TERGESEN

The extra half a million dollars seemed to come so easily—on paper, at least.

In 2021, Nikole Flores and Rocco Savage bought an 1,800-square-foot home in Miami Shores, Fla., for \$875,000. The real-estate market rose, they added a pool and pergola, and today the house is worth an estimated \$1.35 million.

After accounting for mortgage payments, their home equity—the portion of their home they own outright—grew by about \$525,000. But there was another surprise: Their property taxes have increased by more than 50% since the purchase after multiple reassessments, to nearly \$21,000 annually.

They know this is a fortunate problem to

have, especially since they can still pay their bills. But the higher property taxes have pushed them to trim discretionary spending.

"If property taxes continue to rise, I feel like even if I pay off my house I'm essentially still paying rent," said Savage.

Americans have hit an odd contradiction: They have amassed \$35 trillion of wealth in their homes, yet many feel less well off because of it.

Home equity has climbed nearly 80% since early 2020—up from \$19.5 trillion—thanks to a turbocharged rise in house prices. That was about twice the rise in financial wealth including stocks and bonds as of the end of 2024, according to the Federal Reserve.

Yet rising home values also often translate

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Navy SEAL. Doctor. Astronaut. Guy You Hope Mom Doesn't Meet.

Jonny Kim's achievements have been a source of inspiration—and mild dismay

By STU WOO

In half a lifetime, Jonny Kim has achieved the American dream three times over. He was a Navy SEAL. Then he graduated from Harvard Medical School. And on Tuesday, he blasted off as part of his latest act: astronaut.

When novelist Wesley Chu learned about Kim, a 41-year-old father of three who is also a Navy pilot, his first reaction was awe. His second: "Thank God my

mom is not friends with his mom."

After word of his feats spread, Kim became a global source of inspiration. And yet, to many of the same people who glance at his résumé and can't help but compare it to theirs, he has also conjured up a bit of another feeling. Dismay.

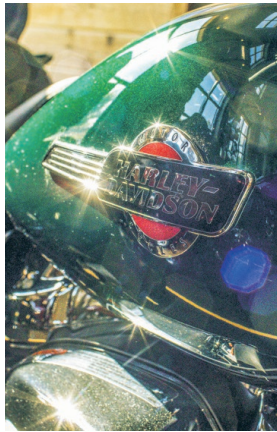
This has been especially true in the Asian-American community, where Kim, the son of South Korean immi-

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INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Americans treasure their clutter—and are drowning in all their stuff. **A9**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Harley-Davidson seeks a new CEO as it grapples with sales slump. **B1**

NICOLE NERI FOR WSJ